New Zealand Rogaining Championships 2007

Planners Report No.1

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Excellent training for the imminent World Rogaine Champs in NSW is how I would describe planning the NZ Champs for next year. Seven days of planning so far, with a day or so to go to tidy up a couple of corners. Not all walking, plenty of 4X4 driving on many farm tracks.

One 8 hour outing with son Richard was really training for the Worlds but we managed to mark three control sites and shoot 36 goats (with permission). I have seen many goats and the other day I heard a grunt shortly after I sat down to mark a control site and out of the scrub to my left came 3 adult and 6 weaner pigs. They ran past me ten metres away and didn't notice me at all.

What's it like? Typical south Marlborough country, not unlike a lot of North Canterbury. Certainly not flat but plenty of farm tracks (not all marked), some prickly stuff in places but pretty clear overall. Have a look at the photos on this web site.

We started with ten properties and it looked like we would have no out-of-bounds on the map, but two landowners have since chosen to withdraw. This caused a rethink, and after discussions with, and indeed encouragement from, the remaining landowners we decided to continue, working around the withdrawn properties. We have also added another property to make it nine in total. I consider it a privilege to work with these farming people and have enjoyed my outings onto their properties. It is their goodwill that enables us as rogainers to enjoy our sport.

There are a total of 73 controls: plenty of easy ones and certainly some harder ones, plenty of contour lines in places but lots of easier routes if looked at carefully. Pre-start planning and strategy will be very important because there are areas of the map that are a long way from home. We are considering having an outpost offering cups of tea and some food in addition to the Hash House at the start/finish.

Vetters will now check the control sites and I will start looking at what points to assign them. Entry forms should be available from this website in November sometime. Marlborough is a great place to visit, and this is an opportunity for North Island Rogainers to come and enjoy some of our South Island country.

Alan Holdaway
Planner